

Sings by

Si Burick

DAILY NEWS SPORTS EDITOR



Brock's Nifty Japanese Slide Came Just '\$4,000 Too Late'

SALISBURY, N. C. — Notes of a baseball traveler, left over from the Florida training camps . . .

Lou Brock, baseball's premier base-stealer, on doing his thing for the St. Louis Cardinals during spring training games: "When I get on base, somebody usually says to me, 'you're not going to try to steal in an exhibition game, are you?'"



Brock

"I wonder why they'd think I wouldn't. Spring training is for perfecting yourself on the things you're best at and improving yourself in every respect. Whenever I get the chance, I'll steal."

Brock on new Red Bobby Tolan, his former St. Louis teammate, who's young and fast: "Bobby's got what it takes to be a fine base stealer. He has to become not afraid to steal; he has to lose his timidity. Playing every day for Cincinnati may do it for him. On the Cards, he didn't play often enough. He couldn't build up confidence when he wasn't playing every day."

Brock tells about sliding home in an exhibition game in Japan last fall and a later comment from a teammate: "It was a play something like the one in the World Series when I didn't slide. This time I did for the simple reason that the catcher wasn't blocking the plate like Bill Freehan was."

"So when I slid and made it, some wise guy on our side said, 'Great slide, Lou. It came just \$4,000 too late.'" (And that's another example of the light-headed air on the St. Louis Cards to whom nothing or nobody is sacred.)

Brock on his future: "I'm still a hungry ball player. Sure, I'm making big money now, but I'm hungry because I don't believe I've had my best year yet." (Lou is 29. His top stealing mark was 74 in 1966. Maury Wills holds the modern record with 104.)

—White Revenge-Minded

BILL WHITE of the Phils, who could wind up as a lefthanded Cincinnati pinch hitter, tells why he decided to come back at 35 after announcing his retirement:

"Look, I was perfectly serious about retiring. I even gave

Burick Receives Award Tonight

Si Burick is in Salisbury, N. C., to accept his seventh consecutive award as *Ohio's elected Sports Writer of the Year* at the *National Sportscasters and Sportswriters Awards dinner*. On tonight's program Burick will induct J. G. Taylor Spink, late publisher of the *Sporting News*, in the *NSSA Hall of Fame*.

The posthumous award will be accepted by Mr. Spink's son, C. C. Johnson Spink, present publisher of that publication.

Previous Hall of Fame inductees were Grantland Rice, Ted Husing, Graham McNamee, Damon Runyon and Ring Lardner.

all my stuff away. It's no fun playing ball when you're hitting .23 this 1968 average).

"I've got a good winter job, I'm tied up contractually with a TV station in Philly, for two years. I wanted to make sure I wouldn't jeopardize the contract if I went back to baseball. They told me they wanted me back next winter, and even assigned me to do a pre-game show this season."

"Why did I decide to come back to baseball? Well, I woke up one day and told myself I had a score to settle with the pitchers who embarrassed me so much last year."

The Hiram college graduate had a full TV schedule after the '68 baseball season. He did several three-minute sports segments daily. In the fall, he was the voice on televised University of Pennsylvania games, which were shown to viewers on Sunday. ("The ratings showed we had more viewers than the Sunday telecasts of Notre Dame games on another station," Bill said, proudly.)

White also broadcasts college track and college wrestling. ("It's a job making that sound interesting, but we picked up a following.") Then, a couple of week ends ago, he got permission from the Phils to fly to Harrisburg to telecast the Pennsylvania State high school basketball tournament finals on a state network.

He'll do all right.

—Ex-Wing LL Executive

IN PRE-WORLD War II days, Mickey McConnell was business manager of the Dayton Wings, a Brooklyn Dodgers farm in the Mid-Atlantic league. Mickey and his field manager, Andy Cohen, made up a happy Abie's Irish Rose combination.

McConnell later turned to the then budding Little League movement and has made a career of it. Today, he is an executive at LL, headquarters in Williamsport, Pa. His title is Director of Training.

Mickey is rightfully proud of the Little League movement. There is scarcely a ball player in the big leagues today, who didn't get his start in the Little League. A relatively few years ago, Joe's day, a pitcher now retired, who helped the Reds win the pennant in 1961, received wide attention as the first Little Leaguer to make it.

Last year, there were 7,000 leagues embracing 2 million kids in each of the 50 states, every province of Canada and 28 other countries. The last two Little League World Series have been won by Japan. There is interest now in a number of European countries, but Belgium and Holland have made the greatest baseball progress, according to McConnell.

Andy Cohen, who managed the Dayton club in McConnell's Dayton time, is in business in El Paso. His volunteer avocation, naturally because of Mickey's influence, is the "El Paso School for Little Leaguers."